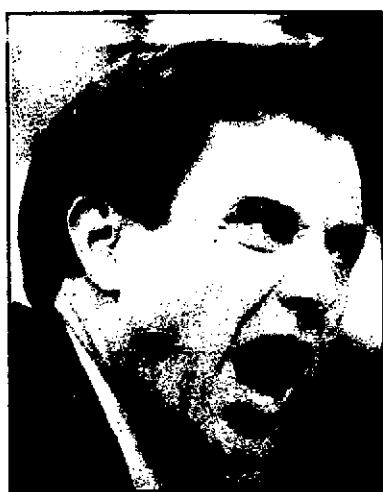


**WILDCATS
ROAR ON**
UK coach
Rick Pitino
has reason
to yell
after yet
another
victory
C3



COLLEGE BASKETBALL

Buckeyes just what
Penn State needed

C4

BOYS BASKETBALL

St. Edward rolls
to district crown

C5

AUTO RACING

Crash puts pole-sitter
at back of the line

C7

Sports

The Chronicle / SUNDAY, MARCH 10, 1996 **C1**



DAN COUGHLIN

Cleveland picks NFL over kids

What an ironic coincidence of timing when the Cleveland public schools announced the end of high school football because there is no money to subsidize it. Not only is high school football abolished, but all sports and all other extracurricular activities will cease to exist in the Cleveland schools. Teachers will be fired. Another high school will be closed.

The announcement was made Thursday afternoon in the Board of Education Building on East Sixth Street.

At the same time, about 200 yards to the north — the length of two football fields — Cleveland city council was debating how much ransom to pay the National Football League to subsidize pro football in Cleveland.

This was not a convergence — it was a head-on collision of priorities. Explain how a rational society can justify taking money from its own impoverished children and handing it over to carpetbagger millionaires.

But in a struggle for survival between the weak and the powerful, you know which side to bet on. Society's food chain gobbles up the disadvantaged and scatters their bones.

Those of us living out here a safe distance from Cleveland have watched the disintegration of that city's school system for almost 20 years.

They began to crumble on the day U.S. Federal Judge Frank Battisti forced busing on the Cleveland school children in the late 1970s.

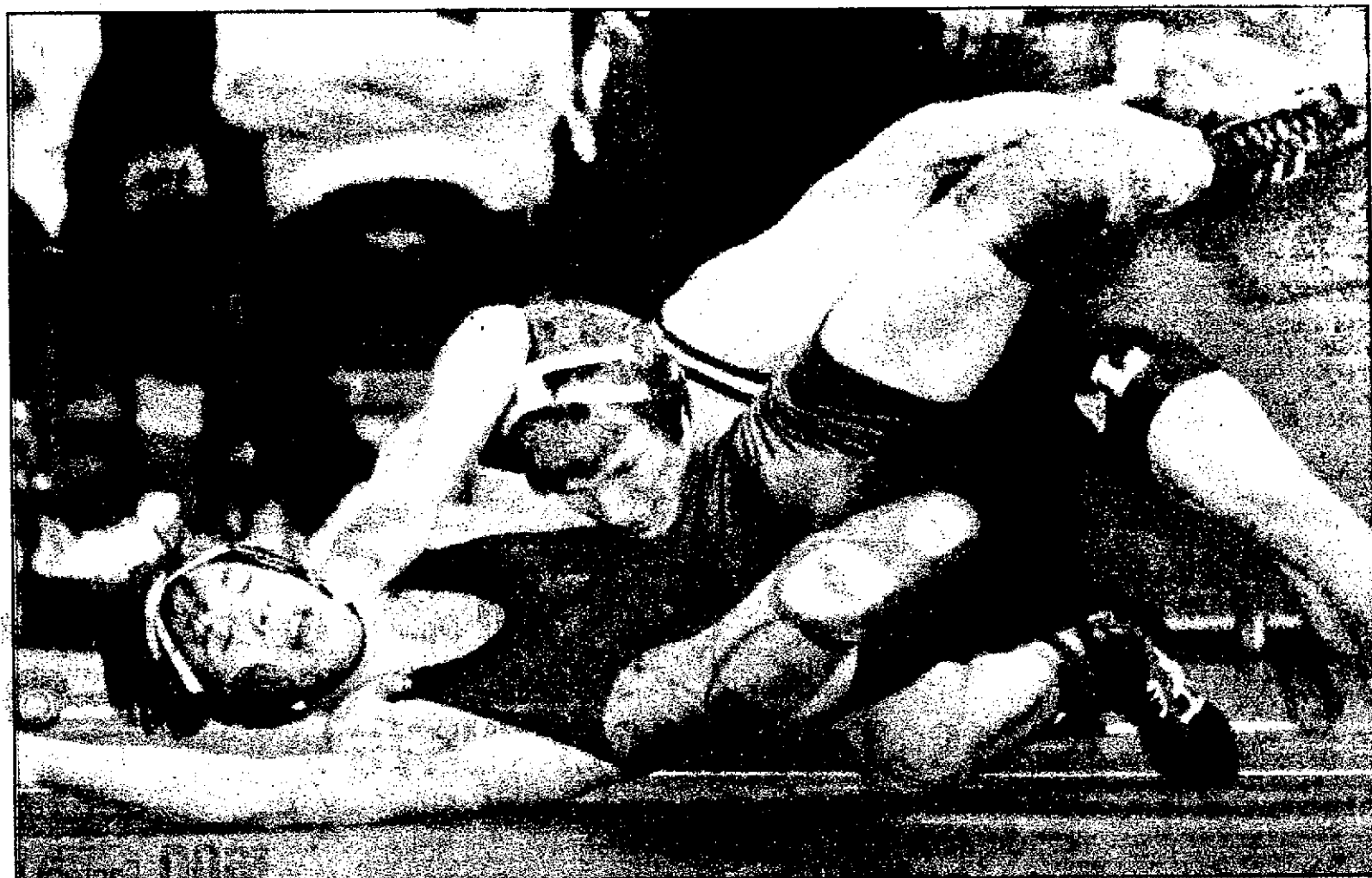
He could just as easily have triggered a nuclear blast on Public Square. That ruling destroyed a city.

Even though it was madness, those who protested were called racists. Reporters and commentators who spoke against it were censored by their editors. Common sense was squelched.

It was intended to homogenize the city by mixing white kids with black kids in the public schools by putting them on buses

See **COUGHLIN, C2**

Six area wrestlers win state



STATING HIS CASE: Avon Lake's Shawn Bristow, top, on the way to the 130-pound title in Division II.

AP / SPECIAL TO THE CHRONICLE

Burnett EC's 1st champ in 20 years

Judie Asp
The Chronicle-Telegram

FAIRBORN — The drought is over for Elyria Catholic.

Unbeaten sophomore Scott Burnett claimed the 112-pound championship on Saturday, earning Elyria Catholic's first state title in 20 years.



Burnett

In addition, the Panthers posted their highest team place, finishing fourth in Division III with 58½ points. Delta won the small school division with 96½ points.

"Four years ago, I was sitting in the stands eating hot dogs," said four-year Panther coach John McNulty. "If everything fired right, we

See **BURNETT, C6**

Elyrian stands tall as Ed's lone champ

Judie Asp
The Chronicle-Telegram

FAIRBORN — Call him champion.

Elyria resident Yoshi Nakamura won the Division I 140-pound state championship Saturday at the 59th Annual State Wrestling Tournament.

The 36-3 junior, in his first state appearance at Wright State University, claimed St. Edward's only championship. Five other Eagle finalists had to settle for second.

Nakamura, stunned three-time state-placer Mike Feeney (44-2) of Dublin Scioto, 11-6.

"All the matches down here were tough," said Nakamura. "I knew I had to beat him (Feeney) with my takedowns. Once I stopped his long shot for a single leg, I was in control."

Walsh Jesuit won its fourth consecutive state title but not without a serious challenge from St. Edward, in the hunt for state championship No. 13.

The Eagles actually held a one-point advantage (130-129) before the afternoon finals.

See **ELYRIAN, C6**

Four winners in Division II

Judie Asp
The Chronicle-Telegram

FAIRBORN — The gold just kept coming in Division II.

Four area wrestlers claimed titles at the 59th Annual State Wrestling Tournament on Saturday at the Ervin J. Nutter Center.

The Southwestern Conference claimed three: Avon Lake's Shawn Bristow (130) and Ryan Pallinger (215), and 145-pound Russ Workman of Olmsted Falls.

Both SWC squads posted their highest state finish ever with Falls taking third with 68 points (four placers) and Avon Lake finishing fifth with 54 points. Akron Coventry won the Division II title with 106 points. Twinsburg Chamberlain nipped the Bulldogs for second with 69 points.

Padua's Jesse Clark of Columbia Station took 125-pound bragging rights.

Olmsted Falls' Nathan Funk was second at 189 pounds, falling 10-4 to St. Paris Graham junior Avery Zerkle (34-1). Funk (32-4) was sixth here last year.

"I was glad to get to the finals but I'm sad that I didn't win it," said Funk. "I am happy with the way the team placed."

Bristow and Pallinger became Avon Lake's second and third state title-holders. Bristow is also the Shoremen's first three-time state-placer.

Workman earned Falls' state title No. 4.

It was sweet revenge for Bristow.

"This is perfect. He (DeShon) got me last week at districts and I got him today," said Bristow, referring to DeShon's previously unblemished 40-0 record.

"My coaches told me all the pressure was on him because he was undefeated and had already beat me this year," Bristow added.

Bristow went into regionals unbeaten only to fall to DeShon 3-2 in the semifinals.

This outing, Bristow prevailed 3-1 on a second-period takedown and third period escape. Bristow (37-1) narrowly missed takedowns on a couple of other occasions. DeShon nearly tied the match with a takedown in the final seconds.

"It was close," said Bristow. "I was getting a little worried. I thought I had another takedown earlier but I didn't get the call."

See **DIVISION II, C6**

Julio's Gold Glove looking tarnished

WINTER HAVEN, Fla. — A few thoughts about the developments to date at Camp Wahoo:

What's the exchange rate between the U.S. and Japan when it comes to a Gold Glove?

Apparently, the Japanese version will get you a cup of coffee and little else.

The Indians could have a situation on their hands down here.

And it's the kind of situation they don't need.

The most interesting thing to watch between now and the time the Indians break camp on March 28 will be how Julio Franco takes to playing first base.

It wouldn't be accurate to say Franco has looked uncomfortable so far. He would have to improve dramatically to get to the point where he looks uncomfortable. Franco has looked hopelessly lost. Even the simple act of getting back to the bag to take a throw makes him look awkward. And we haven't even gotten into fielding the ball, catching the ball, throwing the ball and knowing where to go on cutoffs and rundowns.

John Hart and Mike Hargrove say they're not worried. It's early, they say. Give the guy a chance, they say. But you get the idea when they sit down in their offices, both men put their heads



Steve Herrick
with the *Indians*

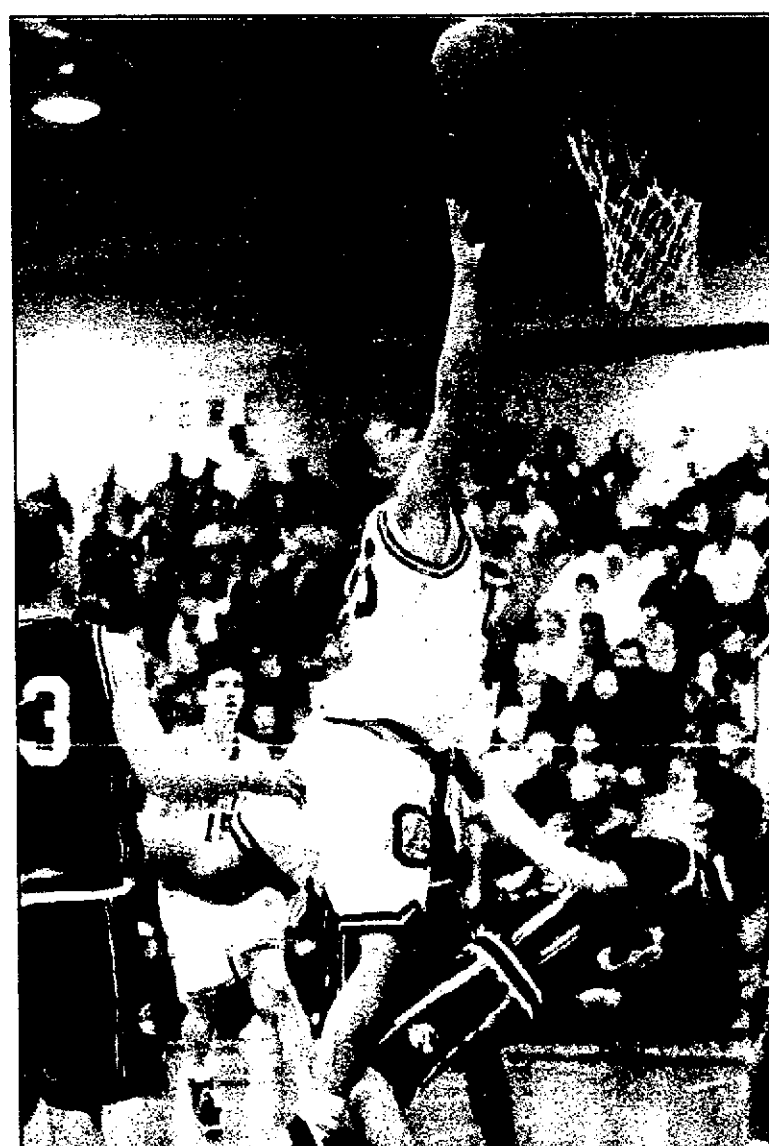
on the desks and start mumbling to themselves.

To Franco's credit, he says he'll do whatever work it takes to get better, indicating perhaps the stories that this is the new and improved Julio are true. The Franco who played for the Indians from 1983-88 cared little about defense and even less about getting better. Criticism and suggestions how to improve his game were something he wouldn't listen to.

The Indians are stuck with Franco, even if he doesn't

See **HERRICK, C2**

THE INDIANS make Albert Belle a contract offer. *Tribe notes, C8.*



CHUCK HUMEL / CHRONICLE

COMING THROUGH: Olmsted Falls' Tim Schaefer bowls over Rocky River's Casey Dolan.

Falls survives on final shot

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

LORAIN — Rocky River had the perfect gameplan for Olmsted Falls and it worked just the way coach Jim Rucki envisioned for 31 minutes and 59 seconds.

But Jerome Moore — ironically Olmsted Falls' defensive specialist — scored his only two points of the district tournament at the buzzer to give Falls a 36-34 win.

Moore scored off a perfect pass from Tim Matus to give Falls its only lead of the night, and send the Bulldogs to the Toledo regional next Wednesday against Columbus East.

"It's a great feeling," said Moore. "I just thank Tim for passing me the ball. I was just sitting on the back post and saw Timmy start to drive. My man swung up to help on Tim and I just stepped in and Tim lobbed me the ball."

"I just happened to look in his direction," said Matus. "I lobbed it up and he made a helluva shot. I don't know how he banked it in."

Olmsted Falls, with a school-record 21 wins in 23 outings,

will make its second straight trip to the Sweet 16. For the 14-10 Pirates it was only their second loss — both to Falls — since a 7-8 start.

The Pirates, losers by 23 and 19 points to Falls earlier this year, played the game possession by possession and had the Bulldogs reeling. Rocky River spread the floor with either Chad Standing or Sean Kennedy looping their way to the basket, patiently waiting for a layup.

"I thought about this real, real early in the year," said Rucki. "We were in a position where the second time we played them, we weren't going to win the conference. No use doing it then. We figured we'd save it."

"We thought we had a shot if we took advantage of the one thing we had over them. Our post players are small but they handle the ball a little bit and have some quickness. We could give them some trouble that way."

The strategy worked to perfection as River led, 12-2, without missing a field goal attempt in the first period.

See **FALLS, C2**